

1. 否极泰来。(Pǐ jí tài lái)

Peace replaces extreme evil.

Explanation: If you find yourself in a hard place don't be discouraged because all nightmares end.

2. 老骥伏枥，志在千里。(Lǎojì fú lì, zhì zài qiānlǐ)

An old warhorse in the stable still longs to gallop a thousand miles.

Explanation: You're never too old to live out a dream, just because you have aged doesn't mean you are no longer allowed to be the happiest version of yourself.

3. 吃得苦中苦，方为人上人。(Chī dé kǔzhōngkǔ, fāng wéi rénshàng rén)

Enduring deepening pain is how man ascends.

Explanation: Pain in your life isn't the end of the world, instead we can learn from it and become better people. Similar to the saying of no pain no gain.

4. 不能一口吃成胖子。(Bù néng yī kǒu chī chéng pàng zi)

You can't get fat with one mouthful.

Explanation: If you want something you have to be patient and persevere because good things take time. Things aren't accomplished straight away, don't give up.

5. 星星之火，可以燎原。(Xīng xīng zhī huǒ, kě yǐ liáo yu)

Starlight shines far.

Explanation: A single spark can start a huge blaze, so be mindful of the things you do, be motivated to be a better person.

You may also be interested in: [13 Famous Chinese Poems with English Translations](#)

1. 广交友，无深交。(Guǎng jiāo yǒu, wú shēn jiāo)

Numerous friends means no deep friendship.

Explanation: The less friends you have the more of a connection you have, it's better to have quality friendships with a few people rather than having many friends and not feeling comfortable around any of them. A friend to everybody is a friend to nobody.

2. 道不同，不相为谋。(Dào bù tóng, bù xiāng wéi móu)

Men of different principles don't work well together.

Explanation: The closest friends are those who have similar goals to you, this way you have somebody who understands you and pushes you further to achieve your goals.

3. 患难见真情。(Huàn nàn jiàn zhēn qíng)

In hardship, we see true friendship.

Explanation: Going through hardship exposes your friends true colors, you will be able to determine if they are there for you when you need them. After all, a friend in need is a friend indeed.

4. 凡人不可貌相，海水不可斗量。(Fán rén bù kě mào xiàng, hǎi shuǐ bù kě dòu liang)

Man cannot be judged by looks; seas cannot be measured by the cup.

Explanation: If you judge people purely based on the way they look then you may miss out the truest of friends. Don't judge a book by its cover.

5. 朋友的眼睛是最好的镜子。(péng you de yǎn jīng shì zuì hǎo de jìng zi.)

The best mirror is a friend's eyes.

Explanation: People are often too critical about themselves and undermine themselves. Friends can offer an objective perspective and help us understand ourselves better.

1. 但愿人长久，千里共婵娟。(Dàn yuàn rén cháng jiǔ, qiān lǐ gòng chán juān)

Wishing a person a long life, no matter how far away from the moon they are.

Explanation: No matter how far up you are from your family you will always have some sort of connection to them. A popular [Mid-Autumn Festival](#) saying, this Chinese philosophy proverb is often quoted to convey feelings of love and homesickness.

See also: [5 Chinese Poems About the Mid-Autumn Festival](#)

2. 家和万事兴。(Jiā hé wàn shì xīng)

If the family lives in harmony, all affairs will prosper.

Explanation: Family comes first. If the family is divided, then things will fall apart, and nothing in their lives will be successful.

3. 不当家，不知柴米贵。(Bù dāng jiā, bù zhī chái mǐ guì.)

One can't tell the cost of the fuel and rice without being the head of the family.

Explanation: Only those who take responsibilities know how difficult it is to get anything done.

4. 家家有本难念的经。(Jiā jiā yǒu běn nán niàn de jīng)

Every family has its problems.

Explanation There is no such thing as a perfect family, so if members of your family are divided or fighting don't feel discouraged because every family has its problems. Similar to the saying "there are skeletons in every family's closet".

5. 家丑不可外扬。(Jiā chǒu bù kě wài yáng)

Family shames must not be spread abroad.

Explanation: If you care for and respect your family, you will keep family matters to yourself. Giving light to the idea of maintaining your family's honour.

1. 执子之手，与子偕老。(Zhí zǐ zhī shǒu, yǔ zǐ xié lǎo)

Hold hands with you, grow old with you.

Explanation: Expressing the idea of lifelong love and commitment between partners.

2. 爱屋及乌。(Ài wū jí wū)

Love the house and its crow.

Explanation: Similar meaning to the English proverb "Love me, love my dog," this Chinese philosophy quotes advises that if you love someone, you should accept everything and everyone that the person loves.

3. 情人眼里出西施。(Qíng rén yǎn lǐ chū xī shī)

In a lover's eye is the foremost Beauty.

Explanation: Someone who is in love with you sees you as the truest form of beauty. You will always be beautiful to the person who loves you. Beauty is in the eye of the beholder.

4. 当我看着你，我看到我的未来岁月在我的眼 (Dāng wǒ kàn zhe nǐ, wǒ kàn dào wǒ de wèi lái suì yuè zài wǒ de yǎn)

When I look at you, I see the rest of my life in front of my eyes.

Explanation: This proverb is commonly featured in vows when two people are to be wed.

5. 有情饮水饱，无情食饭饥。(Yǒu qíng yǐn shuǐ bǎo, wú qíng shí fàn jī)

With love water is enough; without love, food doesn't satisfy.

Explanation: "Better is a dinner of herbs where love is, than a stalled ox and hatred therewith." Everything is better in life when you have love in it.